Personalized Meal Plan

by Diabetes and Endocrinology Centre

Consolidated Meal Plan

Meal Plan

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner	Snacks
Monday	Moong dal chilla with mint chutney	Rajma quinoa bowl with cucumber salad	Zucchini sabzi with buckwheat rotis	Roasted chana and cucumber sticks
Tuesday	Gluten-free vegetable upma with tofu	Grilled paneer tikka with roasted veggies	Vegetable stir-fry with tofu and millet	Air-fried masala makhana
Wednesday	Besan spinach pancakes with tomato salsa	Tofu palak curry with brown rice	Air-fried kofta curry with quinoa	Low-sodium hummus with carrot sticks
Thursday	Chia seed pudding with berries and nuts	Mixed lentil dal with cauliflower rice	South Indian style sambar with red rice	Greek yogurt with walnuts and flaxseed
Friday	Masala quinoa porridge with steamed spinach	Air-fried soya cutlets with sautéed greens	Spicy bhindi masala with jowar chapati	Spiced moong sprouts chaat
Saturday	Sprouted moong salad with lemon	Chickpea salad with broccoli and pumpkin seeds	Eggplant and lentil stew with gluten-free roti	Berry almond smoothie (no added sugar)
Sunday	Vegetable millet poha with peanuts	Stuffed bell peppers with mixed beans	Mixed vegetable korma with cauliflower rice	Apple slices with peanut butter

Recipes

Moong Dal Chilla with Mint Chutney (Diabetes-Friendly, Low Sodium, High Protein)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 155 kcal
Protein: 10g
Carbs: 19g
Fat: 4g

Ingredients

• Yellow moong dal (split yellow lentils), dry – 1 cup (approx. 200g)
• Fresh spinach leaves, chopped – 1/2 cup (about 20g; optional, for added fiber and nutrients)
• Onion, finely chopped – 1/4 cup (about 30g)
• Fresh coriander leaves, chopped – 2 tbsp
• Green chili, deseeded and chopped – 1 small (adjust to taste)
• Ginger, grated – 1 tsp
• Cumin seeds – 1/2 tsp
• Turmeric powder – 1/4 tsp
• Black pepper powder – 1/4 tsp
• Olive oil or canola oil – 2 tsp (for cooking chillas)
• Filtered water – as needed for batter (approx. 1/2 - 3/4 cup)
• Lemon juice – 1 tsp (for chutney)
• Fresh mint leaves – 1 cup (approx. 30g, tightly packed)
• Fresh coriander leaves – 1/2 cup (approx. 15g, tightly packed)
• Roasted peanuts, unsalted – 1 tbsp (for chutney; optional for extra protein and texture)
• Plain, low-fat yogurt – 2 tbsp (for chutney)
• Garlic clove – 1 small (for chutney, optional)
• Black salt – 1/8 tsp (optional, or omit for strict low sodium)
• Filtered water – as needed for chutney

Instructions

1. Rinse the yellow moong dal thoroughly and soak in enough water for at least 2-3 hours or overnight in the fridge.
2. Drain the soaked dal. In a blender, add the dal, spinach (if using), green chili, ginger, cumin seeds, turmeric, black pepper, and about 1/2 cup of water. Blend to a smooth, thick batter. Add more water if needed, but keep the batter spreadable, not runny.
3. Transfer batter to a bowl. Mix in chopped onion and coriander leaves.
4. Heat a non-stick skillet or use an air fryer griddle insert. Brush lightly with 1/2 tsp oil.
5. Pour a ladleful of batter onto the hot surface and spread into a thin pancake (~6 inches wide). Cook on medium heat until the underside is golden (2-3 mins). Flip and cook the other side for another 2 mins, adding a drop of oil if needed. Repeat for all chillas (makes 4-5).
6. For mint chutney: In a blender, combine mint leaves, coriander leaves, lemon juice, yogurt, roasted peanuts (if using), garlic (if using), black salt (if using), and 2-3 tbsp water. Blend until smooth. Adjust water for desired consistency.
7. Serve hot moong dal chillas with a side of fresh mint chutney.

Gluten-Free Vegetable Upma with Tofu (Low-Carb, High-Protein, Diabetes-Friendly)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 179 kcal
Protein: 13g
Carbs: 13g
Fat: 8g

Ingredients

• 1 cup cauliflower rice (fresh or frozen, finely grated)
• 150g firm tofu (drained, patted dry, and cubed)
• 1/2 cup chopped carrots
• 1/2 cup chopped green beans
• 1/4 cup chopped bell pepper (any color)
• 1/4 cup frozen green peas (optional, for color and fiber)
• 1 small onion, finely chopped
• 1-2 green chilies, finely chopped (optional, adjust to taste)
• 1 tsp ginger, minced
• 1/2 tsp black mustard seeds

- 1/2 tsp cumin seeds
- 6-8 curry leaves (optional, traditional flavor)
- 1/4 tsp turmeric powder
- 1/4 tsp freshly ground black pepper
- 1/2 tsp ground coriander
- 2 tsp olive oil or avocado oil
- 2 tbsp chopped fresh coriander (cilantro) leaves
- Juice of 1/2 small lemon
- 1/4 cup water
- Salt substitute, to taste (use potassium-based salt substitute ONLY IF safe for you; otherwise, minimal sea salt or omit as advised)

Instructions

1. Press the tofu gently to remove excess water. Cut into small cubes.
2. Set the Instant Pot to 'Sauté' (normal) mode. Add oil. Once hot, add mustard seeds and cumin seeds. Let them splutter.
3. Add curry leaves (if using), chopped onion, and green chilies. Sauté for 2-3 minutes until onions are translucent.
4. Add ginger, diced carrots, green beans, and bell pepper. Sauté for another 2-3 minutes.
5. Add chopped cauliflower rice, green peas, turmeric, coriander powder, black pepper, and salt substitute (if using). Mix well.
6. Add cubed tofu and 1/4 cup water. Stir to combine.
7. Cover and cook on 'Sauté' mode (LOW) for an additional 3-4 minutes, stirring occasionally, until vegetables are just tender and tofu is heated through. Avoid overcooking for best texture.
8. Turn off Instant Pot. Add lemon juice and chopped coriander leaves. Mix gently.
9. Serve warm. Optionally, garnish with extra coriander.

Besan Spinach Pancakes with Tomato Salsa

Nutritional Information

Calories: 145 kcal
Protein: 7g
Carbs: 18g
Fat: 4g

Ingredients

- Besan (chickpea flour) – 1 cup (120g)
- Fresh spinach – 1.5 cups (45g), finely chopped
- Red onion – 1/4 cup (30g), finely diced
- Green chili – 1 small (5g), finely chopped (optional, adjust for spice level)
- Fresh coriander (cilantro) – 2 tbsp (5g), chopped
- Ginger – 1 tsp (5g), grated
- Turmeric powder – 1/4 tsp
- Cumin powder – 1/2 tsp
- Black pepper – 1/4 tsp
- Low-sodium baking powder – 1/4 tsp
- Filtered water – 3/4 cup (180ml), adjust for batter consistency
- Olive oil or canola oil – 2 tsp (for greasing pan or air fryer tray)
- Salt – 1/8 tsp (or omit for stricter sodium control)
- Tomato – 1 medium (100g), finely diced
- Cucumber – 1/2 medium (50g), finely diced
- Red onion – 2 tbsp (15g), finely diced
- Fresh coriander – 1 tbsp (2g), chopped
- Lemon juice – 2 tsp
- Black pepper – 1/8 tsp
- Salt – pinch (optional, omit for strict low-sodium)

Instructions

1. In a large mixing bowl, add besan (chickpea flour), turmeric, cumin powder, black pepper, low-sodium baking powder, and (if using) salt. Mix well.
2. Gradually add water, whisking to make a smooth, lump-free batter. The consistency should be similar to pancake batter (not too runny).
3. Fold in chopped spinach, red onion, green chili, ginger, and chopped coriander. Mix gently to combine.
4. Preheat a non-stick skillet over medium heat or set your air fryer to 180°C (350°F). Lightly grease with 1/2 tsp oil.
5. Pour approximately 1/4 cup of batter for each pancake onto the skillet or air fryer tray. Spread into a 4-inch circle.
6. Cook 2–3 minutes on one side (or air fry for 3 minutes), until bubbles appear and edges set. Flip and cook another 2 minutes (or air fry for 2 more minutes) until golden and cooked through.
7. Repeat with remaining batter, adding a little oil as needed. Makes about 6 small pancakes.
8. For the tomato salsa: In a bowl, combine diced tomato, cucumber, red onion, coriander, lemon juice, black pepper, and (if using) a pinch of salt. Mix well. Chill until serving.
9. Serve pancakes warm with a generous spoonful of fresh tomato salsa.

Chia Seed Pudding with Berries and Nuts

Nutritional Information

Calories: 225 kcal
Protein: 11g
Carbs: 14g (net carbs ~8g, fiber ~6g)
Fat: 13g

Ingredients

• Chia seeds – 3 tablespoons (30g)
• Unsweetened almond milk (or other unsweetened non-dairy milk) – 3/4 cup (180ml)
• Plain Greek yogurt, non-fat – 1/4 cup (60g)
• Mixed fresh berries (strawberries, blueberries, raspberries, blackberries) – 1/3 cup (50g), sliced if large
• Crushed unsalted walnuts – 1 tablespoon (7g)
• Crushed unsalted almonds – 1 tablespoon (7g)
• Ground flaxseed – 1 teaspoon (3g)
• Pure vanilla extract – 1/4 teaspoon (optional)
• Stevia or monk fruit sweetener – 1/2 to 1 teaspoon, or to taste (optional, avoid sugar/honey/maple syrup)
• Cinnamon powder – 1/8 teaspoon (optional, for flavor)

Instructions

1. In a medium bowl or jar, combine chia seeds, unsweetened almond milk, Greek yogurt, vanilla extract (if using), stevia/monk fruit sweetener (if using), and cinnamon powder. Stir well until fully combined and no seed clumps remain.
2. Cover and refrigerate for at least 3-4 hours, or overnight, until the pudding thickens to a creamy consistency.
3. Before serving, stir the pudding well. If it is too thick, add a splash of almond milk to loosen.
4. Top with mixed fresh berries, crushed walnuts, crushed almonds, and ground flaxseed.
5. Serve chilled. Enjoy as a breakfast, snack, or dessert.

Masala Quinoa Porridge with Steamed Spinach

Nutritional Information

Calories: 185 kcal
Protein: 11g
Carbs: 24g
Fat: 4g

Ingredients

• Quinoa, rinsed – 1/2 cup (90g)
• Water – 1 cup (240ml)
• Low-fat, unsweetened plain Greek yogurt – 1/2 cup (120g)
• Fresh spinach, washed and chopped – 2 cups (60g)
• Red onion, finely chopped – 2 tablespoons (20g)
• Tomato, finely chopped – 1/4 cup (40g)
• Fresh ginger, grated – 1/2 teaspoon (2g)
• Green chili, finely chopped (optional) – 1/4 piece
• Turmeric powder – 1/4 teaspoon (0.5g)
• Cumin seeds – 1/2 teaspoon (1g)
• Black pepper, freshly ground – 1/4 teaspoon (0.5g)
• Coriander powder – 1/2 teaspoon (1g)
• Olive oil – 1 teaspoon (5ml)
• Fresh cilantro, chopped – 1 tablespoon (2g)
• Lemon juice – 1 teaspoon (5ml)
• Salt substitute (potassium-based, optional, use with physician approval) – pinch or omit
• Water (for steaming spinach) – 1/2 cup (120ml)

Instructions

1. Rinse quinoa thoroughly under cold running water to remove bitterness.
2. Add rinsed quinoa and 1 cup water to the Instant Pot. Close the lid, set to 'Pressure Cook' on high for 1 minute. Allow natural pressure release for 10 minutes, then quick release any remaining pressure.

3. While quinoa cooks, place chopped spinach and 1/2 cup water in a microwave-safe bowl. Microwave on high for 2-3 minutes until wilted, then drain excess water.
4. Heat olive oil in a nonstick pan or Instant Pot 'Sauté' mode. Add cumin seeds; let them splutter. Add onions, ginger, and optional green chili, sauté 2 minutes until soft.
5. Add tomatoes, turmeric, coriander powder, and black pepper. Cook 2-3 minutes until tomatoes soften.
6. Add cooked quinoa to the masala mixture. Stir well to combine.
7. Fold in steamed spinach and cook for 1-2 minutes, mixing thoroughly.
8. Turn off heat. Let mixture cool for 2 minutes, then gently stir in Greek yogurt and lemon juice. Mix until creamy.
9. Garnish with chopped cilantro. Taste and only add salt substitute if recommended by your physician.
10. Serve warm, portioning half the recipe for each serving.

Sprouted Moong Salad with Lemon (Low Sodium, Low Carb, High Protein)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 120 kcal
Protein: 8g
Carbs: 16g
Fat: 3g

Ingredients

• Sprouted green moong beans – 1 cup (about 70g, raw, well rinsed)
• Cucumber – 1/2 cup, finely chopped (about 60g)
• Tomato – 1/2 cup, finely chopped (about 60g, seeds removed for lower glycemic load)
• Red onion – 2 tbsp, finely chopped (about 15g)
• Fresh coriander leaves – 2 tbsp, finely chopped
• Green chili – 1 small, deseeded and finely chopped (optional, adjust to spice tolerance)
• Lemon juice – 1.5 tbsp (about 20ml, freshly squeezed)
• Extra virgin olive oil – 1 tsp (about 5ml; heart-healthy fat)
• Black pepper powder – 1/4 tsp
• Roasted cumin powder – 1/4 tsp
• Fresh ginger – 1/2 tsp, grated (optional, for flavor)

• Salt substitute (potassium-based, optional) – pinch (use only if medically permitted, otherwise omit)
• Iceberg lettuce or salad greens – 1/2 cup (optional, for serving)

Instructions

1. Ensure all vegetables are cleaned and chopped as specified. If using salt substitute, confirm with healthcare provider due to hypertension and medication interactions.
2. In a large bowl, combine sprouted moong, cucumber, tomato, red onion, green chili, coriander leaves, and ginger.
3. In a small bowl, mix lemon juice, olive oil, black pepper, and cumin powder. Whisk well.
4. Pour the dressing over the salad and toss gently to combine. Taste and adjust lemon or pepper if needed.
5. Serve immediately, optionally on a bed of lettuce or salad greens.
6. For extra crunch and glycemic control, refrigerate for 15 minutes before serving (cold temperatures may slow carbohydrate absorption).

Vegetable Millet Poha with Peanuts (Diabetes & Heart Healthy)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 192 kcal
Protein: 6g
Carbs: 26g
Fat: 7g

Ingredients

• Foxtail millet flakes (poha, gluten-free): 3/4 cup (about 40g)
• Raw peanuts: 2 tablespoons (about 16g)
• Olive oil (extra-virgin): 1 teaspoon
• Mustard seeds: 1/4 teaspoon
• Curry leaves: 8-10 leaves
• Fresh ginger, minced: 1/2 teaspoon
• Green chili, finely chopped (optional, for mild spice): 1/2 small
• Red onion, finely chopped: 1/4 cup (about 30g)
• Carrot, grated: 1/4 cup (about 25g)

• Green peas (fresh or frozen): 1/4 cup (about 30g)
• Red bell pepper, diced: 1/4 cup (about 30g)
• Turmeric powder: 1/4 teaspoon
• Salt substitute (potassium-based, optional & only if safe for your potassium levels): 1/8 teaspoon (or omit)
• Fresh coriander leaves, chopped: 1 tablespoon
• Lemon juice: 1 teaspoon

Instructions

1. Rinse the millet flakes (poha) thoroughly in a strainer under running water for 20-30 seconds. Let them drain and rest for 5 minutes to soften.
2. Set Instant Pot or a non-stick pan to 'Sauté' mode (Low). Add olive oil.
3. Add mustard seeds and allow them to crackle (about 30 seconds). Add curry leaves, minced ginger, and green chili; sauté for 1 minute.
4. Add onions and sauté until translucent (2-3 minutes).
5. Add grated carrot, green peas, and red bell pepper. Sauté for another 2 minutes.
6. Add the peanuts and toast for 2 minutes, stirring often.
7. Sprinkle turmeric powder over vegetables. Add the softened millet flakes.
8. Mix gently to combine all ingredients. If mixture feels too dry, sprinkle 1-2 tablespoons of water.
9. Cook for 2-3 minutes, stirring gently. Add salt substitute if using (or skip for stricter sodium control).
10. Turn off heat. Add lemon juice and chopped coriander leaves. Mix gently.
11. Serve warm. Optionally, garnish with extra coriander.

Rajma Quinoa Bowl with Cucumber Salad

Nutritional Information

Calories: 330 kcal
Protein: 15g
Carbs: 44g
Fat: 5g

Ingredients

• Rajma (red kidney beans), dry – 1/2 cup (soaked overnight, drained and rinsed)

- Quinoa, uncooked – 1/2 cup
- Water – 2 1/2 cups, divided
- Low sodium tomato puree – 1/2 cup
- Onion, medium, finely chopped – 1/2
- Garlic, minced – 1 clove
- Ginger, grated – 1/2 inch piece
- Green chili, finely chopped – 1 (optional, for spice)
- Olive oil – 1 tsp
- Cumin seeds – 1/2 tsp
- Turmeric powder – 1/4 tsp
- Ground coriander – 1/2 tsp
- Garam masala – 1/4 tsp
- Paprika – 1/4 tsp
- Fresh cilantro, chopped – 1 tbsp
- Salt substitute (potassium-based, optional) – to taste (max 1/8 tsp)
- Black pepper – 1/4 tsp
- Lemon juice – 1 tbsp
- Cucumber, diced – 1 cup
- Cherry tomatoes, halved – 1/2 cup
- Red onion, thinly sliced – 1/8 cup
- Fresh mint, chopped – 1 tbsp

Instructions

1. 1. Cook the rajma: Add soaked and rinsed rajma with 1 cup water to the Instant Pot. Pressure cook on high for 18 minutes. Let pressure release naturally. Drain and set aside.
2. 2. Cook the quinoa: Rinse quinoa under cold water. In the Instant Pot, add quinoa and 1 cup water. Pressure cook on high for 1 minute, allow natural release for 10 minutes, then quick release any remaining pressure. Fluff with a fork.
3. 3. Prepare the rajma masala: Set Instant Pot to sauté mode. Add olive oil and cumin seeds. Once aromatic, add onion, garlic, ginger, and green chili (if using). Sauté for 2–3 minutes until onions are translucent.
4. 4. Add turmeric, coriander, garam masala, and paprika. Stir for 30 seconds. Add tomato puree and cook for 2–3 minutes until oil begins to separate.
5. 5. Add cooked rajma and 1/2 cup water. Simmer on sauté mode for 5–7 minutes, stirring occasionally. Season with black pepper and salt substitute if using. Stir in lemon juice and chopped cilantro. Turn off the heat.
6. 6. Make the cucumber salad: In a bowl, combine cucumber, cherry tomatoes, red onion, and mint. Toss with a squeeze of lemon juice and a pinch of black pepper.

7. 7. Assemble the bowl: Add a layer of quinoa to a serving bowl. Top with rajma masala and serve cucumber salad on the side. Garnish with extra cilantro and mint if desired.

Grilled Paneer Tikka with Roasted Veggies (Low Sodium, Diabetes-Friendly)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 220 kcal
Protein: 18g
Carbs: 11g
Fat: 12g

Ingredients

• Paneer (low-fat, unsalted): 200g, cut into 1-inch cubes
• Low-fat plain Greek yogurt (unsweetened): 3 tbsp
• Fresh lemon juice: 1 tbsp
• Ginger paste: 1 tsp
• Garlic paste: 1 tsp
• Ground cumin: 1/2 tsp
• Ground coriander: 1/2 tsp
• Garam masala (salt-free): 1/2 tsp
• Ground turmeric: 1/4 tsp
• Red chili powder or paprika (for less heat): 1/4 tsp
• Black pepper: 1/4 tsp
• Olive oil (extra virgin): 1 tbsp, divided
• Bell pepper (red or yellow): 1 medium, cut into 1-inch pieces
• Zucchini: 1 small, sliced into rounds
• Red onion: 1 small, cut into 1-inch pieces
• Broccoli florets: 1 cup
• Fresh coriander leaves: 2 tbsp, chopped (for garnish)
• Fresh mint leaves: 1 tbsp, chopped (for garnish, optional)

Instructions

1. In a large bowl, combine Greek yogurt, lemon juice, ginger paste, garlic paste, cumin, coriander, garam masala, turmeric, chili powder/paprika, black pepper, and 2 tsp olive oil. Mix well to form a marinade.
2. Add paneer cubes to the marinade. Toss gently to coat. Cover and refrigerate for at least 30 minutes (up to 2 hours for more flavor).
3. Meanwhile, prepare vegetables: In a separate bowl, toss bell pepper, zucchini, red onion, and broccoli with 1 tsp olive oil and a pinch of black pepper.
4. Thread marinated paneer and vegetables alternately onto skewers (if using wooden skewers, soak in water for 20 minutes prior).
5. Preheat air fryer to 190°C (375°F) for 3 minutes. Arrange skewers in the basket, ensuring they do not overlap.
6. Air fry for 10-12 minutes, turning once halfway, until paneer is golden and veggies are tender with charred edges. (Alternatively, grill in an oven or pan on medium-high heat, turning occasionally.)
7. Remove from air fryer. Garnish with fresh coriander and mint leaves. Serve immediately.

Tofu Palak Curry with Brown Rice (Low Sodium, Low Carb, High Protein)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 330 kcal
Protein: 17g
Carbs: 38g
Fat: 11g

Ingredients

• Extra-firm tofu – 200g (cubed, drained, and pressed)
• Fresh spinach (palak) – 250g (about 8 cups, washed and chopped)
• Brown basmati rice – 1/2 cup (uncooked, rinsed)
• Onion – 1 medium (finely chopped)
• Tomato – 1 medium (chopped)
• Fresh ginger – 1-inch piece (peeled and minced)
• Garlic – 2 cloves (minced)
• Green chili – 1 small (optional, finely chopped, remove seeds for less heat)
• Ground cumin – 1/2 tsp
• Ground coriander – 1/2 tsp

• Turmeric powder – 1/4 tsp
• Garam masala – 1/4 tsp (no salt added, optional)
• Black pepper – 1/4 tsp
• Olive oil or canola oil – 2 tsp
• Fresh lemon juice – 1 tsp
• Low sodium vegetable broth – 1/2 cup (unsalted, or use water)
• Fresh cilantro – 1 tbsp (chopped, optional for garnish)

Instructions

1. Start by cooking the brown basmati rice: In the Instant Pot, add 1/2 cup rinsed brown rice and 1 cup water. Close the lid, set valve to sealing, and cook on high pressure for 22 minutes. Allow natural release for 10 minutes, then quick release any remaining pressure. Fluff and set aside.
2. While rice cooks, prepare the palak (spinach) puree: In a pot, bring 2 cups water to boil. Add spinach leaves and blanch for 1–2 minutes until just wilted. Drain and immediately transfer spinach to a bowl of ice or cold water to retain color. Drain again and blend spinach with half of the chopped green chili (if using), ginger, and garlic until smooth. Set aside.
3. Pat tofu cubes dry. In the Air Fryer, arrange tofu cubes in a single layer and spray lightly with oil. Air fry at 180°C/350°F for 10 minutes, shaking halfway, until lightly golden. (Alternatively, pan-sear with 1 tsp oil until lightly browned.) Set aside.
4. In the Instant Pot (on Sauté mode), heat 1 tsp oil. Add onions and sauté 3–5 minutes until translucent. Add chopped tomato, cumin, coriander, turmeric, and black pepper. Cook for 3–4 minutes until tomatoes soften.
5. Pour in the blended spinach mixture and low sodium broth (or water). Stir well, bring to a simmer, and cook for 5 minutes.
6. Add the air-fried tofu cubes and garam masala (optional). Simmer for another 2–3 minutes to combine flavors.
7. Turn off heat. Stir in fresh lemon juice. Taste and adjust seasoning (no added salt).
8. Serve the tofu palak curry hot over a portion of brown basmati rice. Garnish with chopped cilantro if desired.

Mixed Lentil Dal with Cauliflower Rice (Low Sodium, Diabetes-Friendly, Vegetarian)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 225 kcal
Protein: 15g
Carbs: 30g
Fat: 5g

Ingredients

- Red lentils (masoor dal), dry – 1/4 cup (50g)
- Yellow split moong dal, dry – 1/4 cup (50g)
- Green lentils (whole moong), dry – 1/4 cup (50g)
- Water – 3 cups (for dal)
- Turmeric powder – 1/2 tsp
- Fresh ginger, minced – 1 tsp
- Garlic, minced – 2 cloves
- Onion, finely chopped – 1 small (70g)
- Tomato, finely chopped – 1 medium (90g)
- Green chili, deseeded & finely chopped – 1 (optional)
- Cumin seeds – 1/2 tsp
- Mustard seeds – 1/2 tsp
- Coriander powder – 1 tsp
- Garam masala – 1/2 tsp
- Olive oil or cold-pressed canola oil – 1 tbsp
- Fresh cilantro, chopped – 2 tbsp
- Lemon juice – 2 tsp
- Cauliflower florets – 1 medium head (500g), riced
- Black pepper – 1/4 tsp
- Salt substitute (potassium-based, optional)* – 1/4 tsp or to taste

Instructions

1. Rinse all lentils thoroughly under cold water. Soak in water for 15 minutes, then drain.
2. Set Instant Pot to sauté mode. Add olive oil, cumin seeds, and mustard seeds. Let them splutter (about 30 seconds).
3. Add minced ginger, garlic, and onion. Sauté for 2-3 minutes until onions are translucent.
4. Add chopped tomato and green chili (if using). Cook for another 2 minutes.
5. Stir in turmeric, coriander powder, and garam masala.
6. Add soaked lentils and 3 cups water. Stir well.
7. Close Instant Pot lid, set valve to sealing. Pressure cook on HIGH for 10 minutes.
8. Quick release pressure. Stir well and mash gently for a creamy texture.
9. Stir in lemon juice and chopped cilantro. Adjust seasoning with black pepper and salt substitute (if using). Set aside, keep warm.
10. For cauliflower rice: If using whole cauliflower, pulse florets in a blender or food processor until rice-sized grains form.
11. In a non-stick pan or Instant Pot on sauté mode, add riced cauliflower. Dry roast for 3-4 minutes until just tender. Season with black pepper and a pinch of salt substitute (optional).

12. Serve a portion of dal over a bed of cauliflower rice. Garnish with extra cilantro and a wedge of lemon if desired.

Air-Fried Soya Cutlets with Sautéed Greens

Nutritional Information

Calories: 156 kcal
Protein: 13g
Carbs: 17g
Fat: 4g

Ingredients

• Soya granules (unsweetened, non-GMO): 1 cup (dry, ~60g)
• Boiled potatoes (small, peeled, mashed): 1/4 cup (~50g)
• Carrot (finely grated): 1/4 cup (~25g)
• Green peas (fresh or frozen, thawed): 2 tbsp (~18g)
• Onion (small, finely chopped): 2 tbsp (~16g)
• Fresh cilantro (finely chopped): 2 tbsp
• Fresh ginger (grated): 1 tsp
• Green chili (optional, finely chopped): 1/2 tsp
• Ground cumin: 1/2 tsp
• Ground coriander: 1/2 tsp
• Black pepper: 1/4 tsp
• Garam masala (salt-free): 1/4 tsp
• Turmeric: 1/4 tsp
• Lemon juice: 1 tbsp
• Salt substitute (potassium-based, optional, check with provider): 1/8 tsp or omit
• Besan (chickpea flour, gluten-free): 2 tbsp
• Olive oil spray: as needed
• Mixed greens (e.g., spinach, kale, Swiss chard): 2 cups (~60g)
• Garlic (minced): 1 tsp
• Olive oil: 1 tsp

• Black pepper (for greens): 1/8 tsp
• Fresh lemon juice (for greens): 1 tsp

Instructions

1. Prepare soya granules: Soak 1 cup soya granules in hot water for 5 minutes. Drain and squeeze out excess water thoroughly.
2. In a large bowl, combine rehydrated soya granules, mashed potato, grated carrot, green peas, onion, cilantro, ginger, green chili (if using), cumin, coriander, black pepper, garam masala, turmeric, lemon juice, and salt substitute (if using). Mix well.
3. Add chickpea flour (besan) to the mixture as a binder. Mix until a dough-like consistency forms.
4. Divide the mixture into 8 equal portions and shape into flat, round cutlets (about 2 inches across).
5. Lightly spray both sides of each cutlet with olive oil spray.
6. Preheat the air fryer to 180°C (350°F) for 3 minutes.
7. Place cutlets in a single layer in the air fryer basket. Cook at 180°C (350°F) for 10-12 minutes, flipping once halfway, until golden brown and crisp.
8. While cutlets cook, prepare the sautéed greens: Heat 1 tsp olive oil in a nonstick pan over medium heat. Add minced garlic and sauté for 30 seconds.
9. Add mixed greens and cook, stirring, for 2-3 minutes until wilted. Season with black pepper and a squeeze of lemon juice. Remove from heat.
10. Serve 2 cutlets per serving (makes 4 servings) with a generous side of sautéed greens.

Chickpea Salad with Broccoli and Pumpkin Seeds

Nutritional Information

Calories: 270 kcal
Protein: 11g
Carbs: 28g
Fat: 12g

Ingredients

• Chickpeas (cooked, drained, no salt added) – 1 cup (165g)
• Broccoli florets – 1 cup (90g)
• Cherry tomatoes – 6 (about 75g), halved

• Cucumber – 1/2 medium (75g), diced
• Red bell pepper – 1/2 medium (60g), diced
• Red onion – 2 tablespoons (20g), finely chopped
• Fresh cilantro or parsley – 2 tablespoons, chopped
• Raw pumpkin seeds (pepitas, unsalted) – 2 tablespoons (18g)
• Extra virgin olive oil – 1 tablespoon (15ml)
• Fresh lemon juice – 1 tablespoon (15ml)
• Ground cumin – 1/4 teaspoon
• Black pepper – 1/4 teaspoon
• Garlic powder – 1/8 teaspoon (optional)
• Water – as needed for steaming

Instructions

1. Prepare broccoli: Place broccoli florets in a microwave-safe bowl with 2 tablespoons water. Microwave on high for 2 minutes until just tender but still bright green. Drain and let cool.
2. In a large mixing bowl, combine cooked chickpeas, steamed broccoli, cherry tomatoes, cucumber, red bell pepper, red onion, and chopped cilantro or parsley.
3. In a small bowl, whisk together olive oil, lemon juice, ground cumin, black pepper, and garlic powder (if using).
4. Pour the dressing over the salad ingredients. Toss gently to combine.
5. Add pumpkin seeds and give the salad a final toss.
6. Serve immediately, or chill in the fridge for 20-30 minutes to let flavors meld.

Vegetarian Stuffed Bell Peppers with Mixed Beans (Low Carb, High Protein, Low Sodium)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 175 kcal
Protein: 12g
Carbs: 19g
Fat: 5g

Ingredients

- 4 medium bell peppers (any color), tops cut off and seeds removed
- 1 cup cooked mixed beans (unsalted; combination of black beans, kidney beans, and chickpeas)
- 1/2 cup firm tofu, crumbled
- 1/2 cup cauliflower rice (fresh or frozen)
- 1/2 cup diced tomatoes (no salt added, drained)
- 1/2 cup chopped spinach (fresh or frozen, thawed and squeezed dry)
- 1 small red onion, finely chopped
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 tablespoon extra virgin olive oil
- 1/2 teaspoon ground cumin
- 1/2 teaspoon smoked paprika
- 1/4 teaspoon ground black pepper
- 1/4 teaspoon turmeric powder (optional, for anti-inflammatory benefit)
- 2 tablespoons fresh cilantro or parsley, chopped
- 2 tablespoons shredded part-skim mozzarella cheese (optional, for topping)
- Juice of 1/2 lemon

Instructions

1. Preheat the air fryer to 350°F (175°C), or use an Instant Pot with the baking function if preferred.
2. Prepare the bell peppers by slicing off the tops and removing seeds and membranes. Set aside.
3. In a large bowl, combine cooked mixed beans, crumbled tofu, cauliflower rice, diced tomatoes, chopped spinach, chopped onion, minced garlic, olive oil, cumin, smoked paprika, black pepper, and turmeric. Mix well until evenly combined.
4. Add lemon juice and fresh cilantro or parsley. Mix again.
5. Stuff each bell pepper with the bean/vegetable mixture, packing gently but firmly.
6. Top each pepper with a small sprinkle (about 1/2 tablespoon) of shredded mozzarella cheese, if using.
7. Place stuffed peppers upright in the air fryer basket or Instant Pot (on a trivet for even cooking).
8. Air fry at 350°F (175°C) for 12-15 minutes, or until peppers are tender and filling is heated through. If using Instant Pot bake function, cook for 15-20 minutes.
9. Let cool for 5 minutes before serving.

Zucchini Sabzi with Buckwheat Rotis

Nutritional Information

Calories: 230 kcal
Protein: 6 g
Carbs: 36 g
Fat: 5 g

Ingredients

• Zucchini – 2 medium (approx. 300g), diced
• Onion – 1 small (approx. 80g), finely chopped
• Tomato – 1 small (approx. 80g), finely chopped
• Green chili – 1 small, finely chopped (optional, adjust for spice)
• Ginger – 1 tsp, grated
• Garlic – 2 cloves, minced
• Coriander powder – 1 tsp
• Turmeric powder – 1/4 tsp
• Cumin seeds – 1/2 tsp
• Fresh coriander leaves – 2 tbsp, chopped
• Olive oil – 2 tsp
• Water – 1/4 cup
• Lemon juice – 1 tsp
• Black pepper powder – 1/4 tsp
• Buckwheat flour (kuttu ka atta) – 1 cup (120g)
• Low-fat plain yogurt – 2 tbsp (for binding rotis)
• Water – as needed for dough
• Salt substitute (potassium-based, e.g., LoSalt) – 1/4 tsp (optional, or omit)

Instructions

1. Prepare the Zucchini Sabzi: In the Instant Pot (or a nonstick pan), heat 2 tsp olive oil on sauté mode. Add cumin seeds and let them sizzle.
2. Add chopped onion, ginger, and garlic. Sauté until onions are translucent.
3. Add green chili (if using), chopped tomato, turmeric, and coriander powder. Cook for 2-3 minutes until tomatoes soften.
4. Add diced zucchini and stir well. Add 1/4 cup water, black pepper, and salt substitute (if using). Mix thoroughly.
5. Cover and cook on low (or 'Pressure Cook' on LOW for 1 minute, then quick release) until zucchini is just tender but not mushy.

6. Open, add lemon juice and chopped coriander. Stir and set aside.
7. Prepare Buckwheat Rotis: In a mixing bowl, combine buckwheat flour, salt substitute (if using), and 2 tbsp low-fat yogurt. Add water little by little to form a soft dough. Knead gently, as buckwheat dough is delicate.
8. Divide dough into 4 balls. Place each between two sheets of parchment or cling film. Roll gently into 6-inch rotis using a rolling pin.
9. Heat a nonstick skillet. Cook each roti on medium heat for about 1-2 minutes per side, until brown spots appear. Optionally, brush lightly with a drop of olive oil.
10. Serve zucchini sabzi hot with fresh buckwheat rotis. Garnish with extra coriander if desired.

Vegetable Stir-Fry with Tofu and Millet

Nutritional Information

Calories: 330 kcal
Protein: 19g
Carbs: 29g
Fat: 14g

Ingredients

• Extra-firm tofu, drained and cubed – 200g (about 7oz)
• Millet, dry – 50g (1/4 cup)
• Broccoli florets – 60g (about 1 cup)
• Red bell pepper, sliced – 50g (about 1/2 medium)
• Carrot, julienned – 40g (about 1/2 medium)
• Snow peas, trimmed – 40g (about 1/2 cup)
• Baby spinach – 30g (about 1 cup)
• Spring onion, sliced – 20g (2 tbsp)
• Ginger, fresh, minced – 5g (1 tsp)
• Garlic, fresh, minced – 5g (1 tsp)
• Low-sodium tamari (gluten-free soy sauce) – 1 tbsp (15ml)
• Sesame oil – 1 tsp (5ml)
• Olive oil (for sautéing) – 1 tsp (5ml)
• Rice vinegar – 1 tsp (5ml)

• Black pepper, freshly ground – 1/4 tsp
• Toasted sesame seeds – 1 tsp (optional, for garnish)

Instructions

1. Rinse millet thoroughly under cold water. Add millet and 150ml (2/3 cup) water to the Instant Pot. Seal and cook on manual high pressure for 10 minutes. Allow natural pressure release for 10 minutes, then release any remaining pressure. Fluff with a fork and set aside.
2. While millet cooks, pat tofu dry and cut into 1-inch cubes. Optionally, air fry tofu at 200°C (400°F) for 10 minutes, shaking halfway for crispier texture, or pan-sear in a nonstick skillet with 1/2 tsp olive oil until golden on all sides. Set aside.
3. In a large nonstick skillet or wok, heat remaining 1/2 tsp olive oil and sesame oil over medium heat. Add garlic and ginger, stir-fry for 30 seconds until fragrant.
4. Add carrots, broccoli, snow peas, and red bell pepper. Stir-fry for 3-4 minutes until vegetables are just tender-crisp.
5. Add tofu cubes to the pan. Drizzle with low-sodium tamari and rice vinegar. Toss gently to combine and heat through for 1-2 minutes.
6. Add baby spinach and spring onion. Stir for 30 seconds until spinach wilts.
7. Season with freshly ground black pepper. Taste and add more rice vinegar if desired (avoid adding salt).
8. To serve, plate the millet and top with the tofu-vegetable stir-fry. Sprinkle with toasted sesame seeds if using.

Air-Fried Kofta Curry with Quinoa (Low Sodium, Low Carb, High Protein, Vegetarian, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 315 kcal
Protein: 20g
Carbs: 28g
Fat: 11g

Ingredients

• 250g (approx. 1 1/2 cups) extra-firm tofu, pressed and crumbled
• 1/4 cup cooked green lentils (well-drained)
• 1/4 cup grated carrot

- 1/4 cup finely chopped spinach
- 2 tbsp finely chopped onion
- 2 tbsp chickpea flour (besan)
- 1 tbsp fresh cilantro, finely chopped
- 1/2 tsp cumin powder
- 1/2 tsp coriander powder
- 1/4 tsp turmeric powder
- 1/4 tsp garam masala (no added salt)
- 1/2 tsp ground black pepper
- 1 tsp olive oil (for brushing koftas)
- 1 cup cherry tomatoes, halved
- 1/2 cup chopped onion
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 1-inch ginger, minced
- 1/2 tsp cumin seeds
- 1/2 tsp smoked paprika (for color and flavor, optional)
- 1/4 tsp turmeric powder
- 1/4 tsp ground cinnamon
- 1/4 tsp ground black pepper
- 1/2 cup low-fat plain Greek yogurt (unsweetened, unflavored)
- 1/2 cup water
- 2 tsp olive oil (for curry sauce)
- 3/4 cup dry quinoa (rinsed well)
- 1 1/2 cups water (for cooking quinoa)
- Fresh cilantro, for garnish (optional)
- Lemon wedges, for serving (optional)

Instructions

1. Prepare the Koftas: In a large bowl, mix crumbled tofu, cooked lentils, grated carrot, chopped spinach, onion, cilantro, chickpea flour, cumin powder, coriander powder, turmeric powder, garam masala, and black pepper. Mix well using hands until the mixture holds together. If too dry, add 1-2 tsp water; if too wet, add a little more chickpea flour.
2. Shape the mixture into 10-12 small balls (koftas). Brush lightly with 1 tsp olive oil.
3. Preheat the air fryer to 180°C (350°F) for 3 minutes. Arrange koftas in a single layer in the air fryer basket. Air-fry for 12-15 minutes, shaking halfway through, until golden brown and slightly crisp.
4. Prepare the Curry Sauce: While the koftas cook, heat 2 tsp olive oil in a nonstick pan or Instant Pot (sauté mode). Add cumin seeds and let sizzle for 30 seconds. Add onion, garlic, and ginger; sauté for 3-4 minutes until translucent.

5. Add cherry tomatoes, smoked paprika, turmeric, cinnamon, and black pepper. Cook 5-6 minutes until tomatoes are soft. Turn off heat and let cool slightly.
6. Transfer the mixture to a blender. Add Greek yogurt and blend until smooth. Pour back into the pan, add 1/2 cup water, and simmer 3-4 minutes on low heat. Taste and adjust seasoning if needed (avoid adding salt).
7. Cook the Quinoa: Rinse quinoa thoroughly. In a saucepan or Instant Pot, combine quinoa and 1.5 cups water. Bring to a boil, then reduce heat, cover, and simmer for 12-15 minutes (or use 'Rice' setting on Instant Pot). Fluff with fork when done.
8. Assemble: Place cooked quinoa on plates. Top with koftas. Pour warm curry sauce over koftas. Garnish with fresh cilantro and lemon wedges if desired.
9. Serve hot. Portion sizes: 1/2 cup quinoa, 3-4 koftas, and 1/3 of the curry sauce per serving.

Diabetes-Friendly South Indian Sambar with Red Rice

Nutritional Information

Calories: 235 kcal
Protein: 8g
Carbs: 38g
Fat: 3g

Ingredients

• Red rice (uncooked) – 1/2 cup (about 90g)
• Toor dal (split pigeon peas) – 1/2 cup (about 90g)
• Drinking water – as needed
• Mixed vegetables (chopped) – 2 cups (e.g., carrots, green beans, eggplant, pumpkin, bottle gourd, okra; avoid starchy vegetables like potatoes)
• Tomato – 1 medium (chopped, about 100g)
• Onion – 1 small (chopped, about 60g)
• Tamarind pulp – 1 tablespoon (about 15g)
• Sambar powder (salt-free, homemade or store-bought) – 1 tablespoon
• Turmeric powder – 1/4 teaspoon
• Mustard seeds – 1/2 teaspoon
• Cumin seeds – 1/2 teaspoon

• Curry leaves – 8-10
• Asafoetida (hing) – 1 pinch
• Fresh ginger – 1/2 inch piece (finely chopped)
• Green chili – 1 small (slit, optional)
• Olive oil or canola oil – 1 teaspoon
• Fresh coriander leaves – 2 tablespoons (chopped)
• Salt substitute (potassium-based, optional, or omit for very low sodium) – to taste (e.g., 1/4 teaspoon or less)
• Lemon juice – 1 teaspoon (for added flavor, optional)

Instructions

1. Thoroughly rinse the red rice under cool water. Soak for at least 30 minutes.
2. Rinse the toor dal. In the Instant Pot, add toor dal, turmeric powder, 1.5 cups water, and a few drops olive oil. Pressure cook (manual/high) for 8 minutes. Naturally release pressure.
3. While dal cooks, prep vegetables: chop all into bite-sized pieces.
4. Once dal is cooked, mash it lightly. Set aside.
5. In the Instant Pot, set to sauté mode. Add 1 teaspoon olive/canola oil. When hot, add mustard seeds, cumin seeds, curry leaves, asafoetida, and ginger. Let mustard seeds splutter.
6. Add onions, sauté 1-2 minutes until translucent. Add tomatoes and green chili (if using), cook until tomatoes soften.
7. Add chopped mixed vegetables. Stir well.
8. Add sambar powder, tamarind pulp, and 1.5 cups water. Mix.
9. Add cooked dal to the pot. Stir to combine.
10. Close the Instant Pot lid. Pressure cook (manual/high) for 3 minutes. Quick release.
11. Open lid, stir, and adjust consistency by adding more hot water if needed. Add salt substitute or omit for strict low sodium.
12. Switch to sauté mode. Simmer 2-3 minutes. Add lemon juice and chopped coriander leaves at the end.
13. Meanwhile, cook soaked red rice in Instant Pot: Drain soaked rice, add to pot with 1 cup water. Pressure cook (manual/high) for 15 minutes. Natural release.
14. Serve 3/4 cup sambar with 1/3 cup cooked red rice per serving.

Spicy Bhindi Masala with Jowar Chapati (Diabetes-Friendly, Low Sodium, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 192 kcal
Protein: 6g
Carbs: 27g
Fat: 5g

Ingredients

• Bhindi (Okra), fresh, 250g (washed, dried, cut into 1-inch pieces)
• Onion, medium, 1 (finely chopped)
• Tomato, medium, 1 (finely chopped)
• Ginger, fresh, 1-inch piece (grated)
• Garlic, 2 cloves (minced)
• Green chili, 1 small (optional, finely chopped)
• Coriander powder, 1 tsp
• Cumin powder, 1/2 tsp
• Turmeric powder, 1/4 tsp
• Red chili powder, 1/4 tsp (adjust to taste, or omit for less spice)
• Garam masala, 1/4 tsp
• Fresh coriander leaves, 2 tbsp (chopped)
• Cold-pressed canola or mustard oil, 1.5 tsp
• Salt substitute (potassium-based), 1/4 tsp or to taste (optional, consult physician)
• Water, as needed (approx. 2 tbsp)
• Jowar (sorghum) flour, 1/2 cup (approx. 60g)
• Low-fat plain yogurt, 2 tbsp (for dough)
• Warm water, as needed (for dough, approx. 2-3 tbsp)
• Olive oil, 1/2 tsp (for chapati)

Instructions

1. Prepare the Bhindi: Wash and dry bhindi thoroughly to prevent stickiness. Cut into 1-inch pieces.
2. Heat 1 tsp canola or mustard oil in a non-stick pan or in the Instant Pot (Sauté mode). Add chopped onions and sauté until translucent.
3. Add grated ginger, minced garlic, and green chili. Sauté for 1 minute.
4. Add chopped tomato. Cook until soft, about 3-4 minutes. Add turmeric, coriander, cumin powders, and red chili powder. Mix well.
5. Add bhindi pieces and stir to coat with the masala. Add 2 tbsp water, cover, and cook on low heat for 10-12 minutes, stirring occasionally until bhindi is tender but not mushy.

6. Sprinkle garam masala, chopped coriander leaves, and optional salt substitute. Mix and cook uncovered for 2-3 more minutes to reduce any excess moisture.
7. For Jowar Chapati: In a bowl, combine jowar flour, yogurt, and olive oil. Mix. Gradually add warm water, kneading to form a soft, pliable dough. Let rest for 5 minutes.
8. Divide dough into 2 balls. Place each between two sheets of parchment or use a rolling pin to gently roll into 5-inch discs. Jowar dough can crack; patch edges as needed.
9. Heat a non-stick skillet. Cook each chapati on medium heat for 1-2 minutes per side until light brown spots appear. Optionally, finish on an open flame for a few seconds per side for a smoky flavor.
10. Serve bhindi masala hot with jowar chapati.

Eggplant and Lentil Stew with Gluten-Free Roti

Nutritional Information

Calories: 325 kcal
Protein: 16g
Carbs: 46g
Fat: 7g

Ingredients

• Eggplant (brinjal), diced – 1 medium (about 300g)
• Brown or green lentils, dry – 3/4 cup (135g)
• Tomato, chopped – 1 medium (about 120g)
• Onion, finely chopped – 1 small (about 70g)
• Garlic, minced – 3 cloves
• Fresh ginger, grated – 1 tsp
• Spinach, chopped – 1 cup (30g)
• Carrot, diced – 1 small (about 60g)
• Olive oil – 1.5 tbsp (22ml)
• Ground cumin – 1 tsp
• Ground coriander – 1 tsp
• Turmeric powder – 1/2 tsp

• Black pepper, ground – 1/4 tsp
• Red chili powder (optional) – 1/4 tsp
• Salt substitute (potassium-based, optional, or omit for strict low sodium) – 1/4 tsp
• Lemon juice – 1 tbsp
• Fresh cilantro, chopped – 2 tbsp
• Water – 3 cups (720ml)
• For Gluten-Free Roti:
• Chickpea (besan) flour – 1/2 cup (60g)
• Sorghum (jowar) flour – 1/2 cup (60g)
• Psyllium husk powder – 1 tsp
• Olive oil – 1 tsp
• Warm water – 1/3 cup (80ml)
• Black pepper, ground – pinch

Instructions

1. Rinse lentils thoroughly and soak for 20 minutes (optional, for faster cooking). Drain.
2. Set Instant Pot to 'Sauté' mode. Add olive oil, then onion, garlic, and ginger. Sauté for 2-3 minutes until fragrant.
3. Add diced eggplant and carrot. Cook for another 3 minutes, stirring occasionally.
4. Add cumin, coriander, turmeric, black pepper, and (optional) chili powder. Stir for 1 minute.
5. Add chopped tomato, soaked lentils, and water. Mix well. Cancel 'Sauté' mode.
6. Seal Instant Pot lid. Set to 'Pressure Cook' (Manual) on high for 10 minutes.
7. Allow natural pressure release for 10 minutes, then quick release remaining pressure.
8. Open lid. Stir in chopped spinach, lemon juice, and (optional) salt substitute. Simmer on 'Sauté' for 2 minutes.
9. Taste and adjust seasoning as needed. Garnish with fresh cilantro.
10. For Gluten-Free Roti: In a bowl, combine besan and sorghum flours, psyllium husk, black pepper, and olive oil. Gradually add warm water, mixing and kneading to form a soft dough. Divide into 4 balls.
11. Roll each ball between parchment sheets into a circle about 5-6 inches wide.
12. Heat a nonstick skillet or tawa over medium heat. Cook each roti for 1-2 minutes per side until golden spots appear. Keep warm in a cloth.
13. Serve stew hot with gluten-free roti.

Mixed Vegetable Korma with Cauliflower Rice

Nutritional Information

Calories: 230 kcal
Protein: 14g
Carbs: 18g
Fat: 10g

Ingredients

• Cauliflower florets – 1 medium head (about 600g), riced (for cauliflower rice)
• Olive oil – 2 teaspoons (divided)
• Onion – 1 small (80g), finely chopped
• Ginger – 1-inch piece (10g), grated
• Garlic – 3 cloves, minced
• Carrot – 1 small (60g), diced
• Green beans – 50g, chopped
• Green peas (fresh or frozen) – 50g
• Red bell pepper – 1 small (80g), diced
• Zucchini – 1 small (80g), diced
• Firm tofu – 100g, cubed
• Unsweetened plain Greek yogurt – 100g
• Raw cashew nuts – 15g (about 10 nuts), soaked in hot water 15 min
• Low-sodium vegetable broth – 150ml
• Turmeric powder – 1/4 teaspoon
• Coriander powder – 1 teaspoon
• Cumin powder – 1/2 teaspoon
• Garam masala – 1/2 teaspoon
• Ground black pepper – 1/4 teaspoon
• Salt substitute (potassium-based, e.g. LoSalt) – 1/4 teaspoon, or to taste (optional, see tips)
• Fresh cilantro – 2 tablespoons, chopped
• Lemon juice – 1 teaspoon

Instructions

1. Prepare the cashew paste: Drain the soaked cashews and blend them with 1 tablespoon of the Greek yogurt and 2 tablespoons of water until smooth. Set aside.
2. Prepare the cauliflower rice: In a food processor or using a grater, pulse cauliflower florets into rice-sized pieces. Set aside.

3. Set the Instant Pot to 'Sauté' mode and add 1 teaspoon olive oil. Add onions and sauté for 2-3 minutes until translucent.
4. Add ginger and garlic, and sauté for 1 minute.
5. Add carrot, green beans, red bell pepper, zucchini, and tofu cubes. Sauté for 2 minutes.
6. Add turmeric, coriander, cumin, garam masala, black pepper, and (optional) salt substitute. Stir for 1 minute.
7. Add the cashew-yogurt paste and Greek yogurt. Mix well.
8. Pour in the vegetable broth and mix. Cancel 'Sauté', put the lid on, set Instant Pot to 'Pressure Cook' (manual) on LOW for 2 minutes.
9. Quick release pressure and open the lid. Stir in green peas and lemon juice. Let sit on 'Keep Warm' for 2 minutes.
10. While korma is resting, heat 1 teaspoon olive oil in a non-stick skillet. Add cauliflower rice and sauté over medium-high heat for 4-5 minutes until just tender. Do not overcook. Optionally, microwave cauliflower rice for 3-4 minutes instead (no oil needed).
11. Serve korma hot, garnished with fresh cilantro, over a bed of cauliflower rice.

Roasted Chana and Cucumber Sticks

Nutritional Information

Calories: 120 kcal
Protein: 6g
Carbs: 15g
Fat: 3g

Ingredients

• Roasted unsalted chana (whole black chickpeas, dry roasted) – 1/2 cup (about 40g)
• Cucumber – 1 medium (about 180g), peeled and cut into sticks
• Fresh coriander leaves – 1 tablespoon, finely chopped
• Lemon juice – 1 teaspoon
• Freshly ground black pepper – 1/4 teaspoon
• Roasted cumin powder – 1/4 teaspoon
• Extra-virgin olive oil – 1/2 teaspoon (optional, for flavor and heart health)

Instructions

1. Wash, peel, and cut the cucumber into sticks (about 3 inches long). Pat dry with a paper towel.

2. In a medium bowl, combine roasted unsalted chana and cucumber sticks.
3. Add chopped coriander leaves, lemon juice, black pepper, and roasted cumin powder.
4. Drizzle extra-virgin olive oil (if using) over the mixture.
5. Toss gently to coat all ingredients evenly.
6. Serve immediately as a high-protein, crunchy snack.

Air-Fried Masala Makhana (Foxnut) – Diabetes & Heart Friendly

Nutritional Information

Calories: 85 kcal
Protein: 3g
Carbs: 9g
Fat: 3g

Ingredients

• Makhana (foxnuts/lotus seeds) – 2 cups (about 20g)
• Olive oil (extra virgin, or canola oil) – 1 teaspoon
• Roasted cumin powder – 1/2 teaspoon
• Coriander powder – 1/2 teaspoon
• Turmeric powder – 1/4 teaspoon
• Black pepper powder – 1/4 teaspoon
• Chaat masala (low sodium/no added salt) – 1/4 teaspoon
• Kashmiri red chilli powder (for color, optional, not spicy) – 1/4 teaspoon
• Dried curry leaves – 6-8 leaves, crushed (optional)
• Lemon juice – 1 teaspoon
• Fresh coriander leaves – 1 tablespoon, finely chopped (optional, for garnish)

Instructions

1. Preheat the air fryer to 160°C (320°F) for 3 minutes.
2. In a large bowl, add the makhana. Drizzle with olive oil and toss gently to coat all makhana evenly.

3. Add cumin powder, coriander powder, turmeric powder, black pepper, chaat masala, red chilli powder (if using), and crushed curry leaves. Mix gently to coat the makhana.
4. Spread the spiced makhana evenly in the air fryer basket (do not overcrowd; work in batches if needed).
5. Air fry at 160°C (320°F) for 6–8 minutes, shaking the basket halfway through for even roasting.
6. Remove makhana from the air fryer when they are crisp and lightly golden (do not let them brown).
7. Let cool for 2 minutes, then drizzle with lemon juice and toss. Garnish with chopped coriander if desired.
8. Serve immediately as a crunchy, diabetes-friendly snack, or store in an airtight container after cooling.

Low-Sodium Hummus with Carrot Sticks

Nutritional Information

Calories: 185 kcal
Protein: 6g
Carbs: 19g
Fat: 9g

Ingredients

• Chickpeas (cooked, unsalted, drained) – 1 cup (about 165g)
• Tahini (unsalted, unsweetened) – 2 tablespoons (30g)
• Fresh lemon juice – 2 tablespoons (30ml)
• Fresh garlic – 1 clove (minced, about 3g)
• Extra-virgin olive oil – 1 tablespoon (15ml)
• Ground cumin – 1/2 teaspoon (1g)
• Fresh parsley (optional, for garnish) – 1 tablespoon (chopped, 2g)
• Cold water – 2 to 3 tablespoons (30-45ml) as needed for texture
• Carrot sticks (peeled, cut into sticks) – 2 medium carrots (about 120g total)

Instructions

1. 1. Prepare the chickpeas: If using canned chickpeas, drain and rinse thoroughly under running water to remove excess sodium. For dried chickpeas, cook until tender and drain.

2. 2. In a blender, combine chickpeas, tahini, lemon juice, garlic, cumin, and olive oil.
3. 3. Blend until smooth, adding 2 to 3 tablespoons of cold water gradually to reach your desired creamy texture.
4. 4. Taste; if desired, add a small squeeze more lemon juice for extra flavor (instead of salt).
5. 5. Transfer hummus to a serving bowl. Drizzle with a few drops of olive oil and sprinkle with chopped parsley (optional) for garnish.
6. 6. Serve with fresh carrot sticks for dipping.

Greek Yogurt with Walnuts and Flaxseed (Diabetes & Heart-Friendly)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 185 kcal
Protein: 17g
Carbs: 10g (net carbs: ~7g, fiber: ~3g)
Fat: 9g

Ingredients

• 150g (about 2/3 cup) plain, non-fat Greek yogurt (unsweetened, low sodium, no added sugar)
• 15g (about 2 tablespoons) raw walnuts, chopped
• 7g (1 tablespoon) ground flaxseed
• 35g (about 1/4 cup) fresh berries (e.g., blueberries or strawberries, optional for taste and antioxidants)
• 1/4 teaspoon ground cinnamon (optional, for flavor and glycemic control)
• 1-2 drops liquid stevia or monk fruit sweetener (optional, if additional sweetness is needed)

Instructions

1. In a medium bowl, add the Greek yogurt.
2. Sprinkle the ground flaxseed evenly over the yogurt.
3. Add the chopped walnuts on top.
4. If using, add the fresh berries and sprinkle with ground cinnamon.
5. If you prefer more sweetness, add 1-2 drops of liquid stevia or monk fruit sweetener. Mix gently to combine.
6. Serve immediately. Keep refrigerated if not serving right away.

Spiced Moong Sprouts Chaat (Low Sodium, Low Carb, High Protein)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 148 kcal
Protein: 10g
Carbs: 19g
Fat: 3g

Ingredients

• Moong (green gram) sprouts – 1 cup (about 120g, raw and sprouted at home, unsalted)
• Cucumber – 1/2 cup, finely diced (about 50g)
• Tomato – 1/2 cup, deseeded and finely diced (about 50g)
• Red onion – 1/4 cup, finely diced (about 25g)
• Fresh coriander leaves – 2 tbsp, finely chopped
• Green chili – 1 small, finely chopped (optional, adjust to taste)
• Roasted cumin powder – 1/2 tsp
• Chaat masala (no added salt) – 1/4 tsp
• Black pepper powder – 1/4 tsp
• Lemon juice – 2 tsp (freshly squeezed)
• Pomegranate arils – 2 tbsp (optional, for garnish and antioxidants)
• Unsalted roasted peanuts – 1 tbsp, roughly crushed (optional, for crunch and protein)
• Plain low-fat yogurt – 2 tbsp (optional, for extra protein and probiotics)

Instructions

1. 1. If not already sprouted, soak 1/2 cup whole moong beans in water overnight. Rinse, drain, and allow to sprout in a covered container at room temperature for 24-36 hours until small tails form.
2. 2. To enhance digestibility, steam the moong sprouts in an Instant Pot (or stovetop steamer) for 2-3 minutes (use the 'Steam' function on Instant Pot; do not overcook). Let cool.
3. 3. In a large mixing bowl, combine steamed moong sprouts, diced cucumber, tomato, and onion.

4. 4. Add chopped coriander, green chili (if using), roasted cumin powder, chaat masala, and black pepper. Toss gently.
5. 5. Sprinkle lemon juice over the mixture and mix well.
6. 6. If using, fold in pomegranate arils and crushed roasted peanuts.
7. 7. For extra creaminess and protein, spoon yogurt over the chaat or serve on the side.
8. 8. Garnish with extra coriander leaves and serve immediately for best texture and freshness.

Berry Almond Smoothie (No Added Sugar)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 145 kcal
Protein: 8g
Carbs: 13g
Fat: 8g

Ingredients

• 1/2 cup frozen mixed berries (strawberries, blueberries, raspberries, blackberries)
• 1/2 cup unsweetened almond milk
• 1/4 cup plain, nonfat Greek yogurt
• 1 tablespoon almond butter (unsalted, no added sugar)
• 1 tablespoon chia seeds
• 1/2 teaspoon pure vanilla extract
• 3-4 ice cubes

Instructions

1. Place the frozen mixed berries, unsweetened almond milk, Greek yogurt, almond butter, chia seeds, vanilla extract, and ice cubes into a blender.
2. Blend on high speed for 45–60 seconds, or until smooth and creamy.
3. Pour into a glass and serve immediately.

Apple Slices with High-Protein Peanut Butter Dip

Nutritional Information

Calories: 153 kcal
Protein: 6g
Carbs: 18g
Fat: 8g

Ingredients

- 1 small-medium Granny Smith apple (about 150g), washed and cored
- 2 tablespoons natural, unsweetened peanut butter (no added salt or sugar)
- 1 tablespoon plain, low-fat Greek yogurt (unsweetened, vegetarian, and gluten-free)
- 1/4 teaspoon ground cinnamon (optional)

Instructions

1. Slice the apple into 8-10 even wedges. Leave the skin on for extra fiber.
2. In a small bowl, mix the peanut butter and Greek yogurt until smooth and creamy.
3. Sprinkle ground cinnamon on top of the dip if desired.
4. Arrange the apple slices on a plate and serve with the peanut butter-yogurt dip on the side.

Shopping List

Dry Goods

- Yellow moong dal (split yellow lentils) - 300 g
- Red lentils (masoor dal) - 100 g
- Green lentils (whole moong or brown/green) - 300 g
- Toor dal (split pigeon peas) - 100 g
- Chickpea flour (besan) - 300 g
- Sorghum (jowar) flour - 100 g
- Buckwheat flour - 120 g
- Foxtail millet flakes (poha) - 100 g
- Millet (whole, dry) - 100 g
- Quinoa (dry) - 400 g
- Brown basmati rice (dry) - 100 g
- Red rice (uncooked) - 100 g
- Chickpeas (dried or cooked, unsalted) - 400 g
- Rajma (red kidney beans, dry) - 100 g
- Mixed beans (black, kidney, chickpeas, cooked) - 200 g
- Soya granules - 100 g
- Makhana (foxnuts/lotus seeds) - 50 g
- Roasted unsalted chana (whole, dry) - 50 g
- Pumpkin seeds (raw, unsalted) - 20 g
- Raw peanuts (unsalted) - 50 g
- Almonds (unsalted) - 100 g
- Walnuts (raw) - 50 g
- Cashew nuts (raw) - 50 g
- Chia seeds - 100 g
- Ground flaxseed - 50 g
- Psyllium husk powder - 20 g
- Tahini (unsalted, unsweetened) - 50 g
- Almond butter (unsalted, no added sugar) - 50 g

Oils & Vinegars

- Olive oil (extra virgin or regular) - 400 ml
- Canola oil (cold-pressed, optional) - 100 ml
- Sesame oil - 50 ml
- Rice vinegar - 50 ml
- Low-sodium tamari (gluten-free soy sauce) - 100 ml

Canned & Jarred

- Low sodium tomato puree - 200 ml
- Low sodium vegetable broth - 500 ml
- Tamarind pulp - 1 small jar (100 g)

Dairy Alternatives

- Unsweetened almond milk (or other unsweetened non-dairy milk) - 500 ml

Dairy

- Plain low-fat Greek yogurt (unsweetened) - 1 kg
- Low-fat plain yogurt (for chutney or binding) - 250 g
- Part-skim mozzarella cheese (shredded, optional) - 100 g
- Paneer (low-fat, unsalted) - 250 g

Refrigerated - Plant Protein

- Firm tofu / extra-firm tofu - 900 g

Produce

- Spring onion - 0.25 lb
- Red onion - 3 lb
- Onion - 3 lb
- Garlic bulbs - 4 pieces
- Ginger - 0.5 lb
- Green chili - 0.5 lb
- Curry leaves - 1 bunch
- Fresh coriander / cilantro - 3 bunches
- Fresh mint leaves - 1 bunch
- Fresh parsley - 1 bunch
- Fresh dill (if using) - 1 bunch
- Fresh spinach - 1 kg
- Baby spinach - 1 × 250 g bag
- Iceberg lettuce or salad greens - 1 × 250 g bag
- Zucchini - 4 pieces (≈2 lb)
- Broccoli florets - 2 heads (≈3 lb)
- Carrot - 3 lb
- Cauliflower - 2 heads (≈3 lb)
- Cucumber - 3 pieces (≈2 lb)
- Tomato - 4 lb
- Cherry tomatoes - 1 lb
- Red bell pepper - 3 lb
- Bell pepper (any color) - 4 pieces (≈2 lb)
- Green beans - 1 lb
- Green peas (fresh or frozen) - 454 g (1 lb bag)
- Eggplant (brinjal) - 2 pieces (≈2 lb)
- Pumpkin (if using in sambar) - 1 piece (≈2 lb)
- Bottle gourd (if using in sambar) - 1 piece (≈2 lb)

- Okra (bhindi) - 0.5 lb
- Snow peas - 0.5 lb
- Lemon - 8 pieces
- Apple (Granny Smith) - 1 lb (≈3 small apples)
- Pomegranate (for arils, optional) - 1 piece
- Mixed fresh berries (strawberries, blueberries, raspberries, blackberries) - 500 g

Frozen

- Frozen mixed berries - 250 g
- Frozen green peas - 454 g (1 lb bag)
- Frozen cauliflower rice (optional) - 454 g (1 lb bag)

Misc

- Water - As needed
- Ice cubes - 1 tray

Spices & Seasonings

- Cinnamon powder - 50 g
- Cumin seeds - 100 g
- Mustard seeds - 50 g
- Coriander powder - 100 g
- Cumin powder - 50 g
- Turmeric powder - 50 g
- Garam masala (no salt) - 50 g
- Paprika - 30 g
- Red chili powder / Kashmiri red chilli powder - 30 g

- Black pepper (whole or ground) - 100 g
- Chaat masala (no added salt, low sodium) - 30 g
- Asafoetida (hing) - 10 g
- Smoked paprika - 20 g
- Ground cinnamon - 20 g
- Dried curry leaves - 1 small pack
- Salt substitute (potassium-based, e.g., LoSalt) - 1 small container

Baking & Sweeteners

- Vanilla extract (pure) - 1 small bottle (50 ml)
- Stevia or monk fruit sweetener (liquid or powder) - 1 small bottle
- Baking powder (low-sodium) - 1 small tin